

THE ROLE OF DISCOURSE ANALYSIS OR THE ROLE OF DISCOURSE ANALYSIS IN FOREIGN LANGUAGE TEACHING

¹Nabila Durratun Nasyah, ²Della Aprilia, ³Kharisma Ramadhani, ⁴Suparwoto
Sapto Wahono

1,2,3,4 Faculty of Tarbiyah and Teacher Training, Universitas Islam Negeri Kiai
Haji Achmad Siddiq

Email: nabiladurratun@gmail.com, dellaaprilia836@gmail.com,
kharismariris87@gmail.com, wahsapto@uinkhas.ac.id

Abstrak

Discourse Analysis (AW) is an interdisciplinary approach that studies the relationship between language and its social context. In foreign language teaching, AW serves as a tool to understand how language is used in certain social, cultural, and ideological contexts. This approach helps students not only understand the structure of language, but also how language reflects and shapes social reality. In speaking skills, AW enables students to understand the dynamics of conversation, including implicatures and communication strategies used in everyday interactions. This is important for developing effective speaking skills that are appropriate to the social context. In writing skills, AW focuses on the cohesion and coherence of the text, which are important aspects in composing clear and structured writing. In reading skills, AW enables students to read critically by considering the social context and ideology contained in the text. AW also plays a role in increasing students' cultural awareness. By analyzing texts from various cultures, students can understand different values and norms, as well as how culture influences language use. The application of AW in foreign language teaching not only improves students' language skills, but also equips them with critical thinking skills and cultural awareness that are important in cross-cultural communication. Thus, AW becomes an effective tool in forming competent and socially aware foreign language learners.

Key words: Discourse Analysis, Foreign Language Teaching, Language Skills.

Introduction

Foreign language teaching has become a major focus in global education, given the importance of foreign language skills in the era of globalization. However, the challenges in teaching foreign languages often relate to in-depth understanding of the text and the cultural context contained within it. Discourse analysis, particularly the critical discourse analysis approach, offers an in-depth perspective for understanding how language is used in social and cultural contexts, and how this affects foreign language understanding and learning.

Critical discourse analysis is an approach that emphasizes the relationship between language and power in society. In the context of foreign language teaching, this approach helps identify how learning texts represent certain ideologies and how this affects students' understanding of the language. For example, research by Sari Setyonegoro and Priyanto (2025) analyzed news reports on the internationalization of the Indonesian language in the mass media using a critical discourse analysis approach. Norman Fairclough, who reveals how the media shapes nationalist discourse through news texts.

The methods used in critical discourse analysis include three main dimensions according to Fairclough, namely textual dimensions, discourse practices, and social practices. The textual dimension focuses on the structure and language elements in the text; discourse practices examine the process of production and consumption of texts; while social practices underlie the text. The application of this method in teaching is more critical and reflective, and increases students' awareness of the use of language in a social context.

Although critical discourse analysis offers a rich and insightful approach, there is a gap in its application in foreign language teaching. Many teaching materials still pay little attention to the social and ideological dimensions of the text, so that students only understand the language technically without being aware of the social context that surrounds it. This shows the need for integration of critical

analysis discourse in foreign language teaching curriculum to improve holistic understanding.

This article aims to explore the role of critical discourse analysis in foreign language teaching, with a focus on the application of this method in understanding texts and cultural contexts. Through this approach, it is hoped that effective strategies can be found to improve students' foreign language understanding and skills, as well as bridge the gap between theory and practice in foreign language teaching.

Literature Review

Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) has become an important approach in foreign language teaching, particularly in developing speaking, writing, and reading skills. This approach not only focuses on linguistic aspects but also considers the social and cultural contexts behind language use.

In speaking skills, discourse analysis helps students understand meanings that go beyond the literal meaning of sentences. In writing skills, discourse analysis plays a role in providing concepts of cohesion and coherence to produce well-structured texts in terms of both cohesion and coherence. In addition, discourse analysis is also essential in developing critical reading skills. Critical reading is a necessary tool for uncovering deeper information during the reading process. Discourse analysis supports critical reading, as it helps readers avoid easily absorbing and believing the information they receive without reflection.

Although discourse analysis has many benefits, there is a gap in its application in foreign language teaching. Many teaching materials still lack attention to the social and ideological dimensions of texts, causing students to only understand language technically without realizing the surrounding social context. This highlights the need for integrating discourse analysis into the foreign language teaching curriculum to enhance students' holistic understanding.

This article aims to explore the role of discourse analysis in foreign language teaching, focusing on how this method is applied in understanding texts

and cultural contexts. Through this approach, it is hoped that effective strategies can be identified to improve students' foreign language comprehension and skills, as well as to bridge the gap between theory and practice in language teaching.

Methods

This study uses the library research method, which focuses on the collection, analysis, and synthesis of information from various written sources relevant to the research topic. This method is effective for exploring theoretical concepts, analyzing discourse, and understanding cultural contexts in foreign language teaching. The library research method enables researchers to access various perspectives and findings from previous studies, thereby building a strong theoretical foundation for further research. Through this approach, it is expected that a deeper understanding of the role of discourse analysis in foreign language teaching can be achieved, along with its implications for curriculum development and more effective teaching strategies.

Discussion

Discourse Analysis (AW) has become an integral approach in foreign language teaching, enabling teachers and students to understand language not only as a linguistic system, but also as a communication tool influenced by social, cultural, and ideological contexts. This approach helps students develop critical thinking skills and cultural awareness, which are essential in cross-cultural communication.

In the context of speaking skills, AW enables students to understand the dynamics of conversation, including implicatures and communication strategies used in everyday interactions. This is essential for developing effective and socially appropriate speaking skills. For example, research by Martin (2023) emphasized the importance of AW in developing students' critical thinking skills and cultural awareness through analyzing the context and function of language in real situations.

In writing skills, AW focuses on the cohesion and coherence of texts, which are important aspects in composing clear and structured writing. Research by Zhou

et al. (2023) showed that Chinese intermediate English learners were able to produce narrative writing with better in-depth cohesion compared to ChatGPT, highlighting the importance of a deep understanding of text structure in writing.

In reading skills, AW enables students to read critically by considering the social and ideological contexts contained in the text. This is important for developing students' ability to assess and interpret the information they read, as well as to understand how texts can shape readers' views and attitudes.

AW also plays a role in increasing students' cultural awareness. By analyzing texts from different cultures, students can understand different values and norms, and how culture influences language use. For example, a study by Hapsari and Fauzi (2025) revealed cultural representations in Indonesian EFL textbooks through critical discourse analysis, which can improve students' professional communication competence.

The application of AW in foreign language teaching not only improves students' language skills but also equips them with critical thinking skills and cultural awareness that are important in cross-cultural communication. Thus, AW becomes an effective tool in forming competent and socially conscious foreign language learners.

Conclusion

Discourse Analysis (AW) plays an important role in foreign language teaching, not only as a tool for understanding linguistic structures, but also to uncover the social, cultural, and ideological meanings contained in texts. This approach enables students to develop critical thinking skills, cultural awareness, and effective communication skills in cross-cultural contexts. In speaking skills, AW helps students understand the dynamics of conversation, including implicatures and communication strategies used in everyday interactions. In writing skills, AW focuses on the cohesion and coherence of texts, which are essential for composing clear and structured writing. In reading skills, AW enables students to read critically by considering the social context and ideology contained in the text.

In addition, AW also plays a role in increasing students' cultural awareness, helping them understand different values and norms, and how culture influences language use. Thus, the application of AW in foreign language teaching not only improves students' language skills, but also equips them with critical thinking skills and cultural awareness that are important in cross-cultural communication. Therefore, AW becomes an effective tool in forming competent and socially aware foreign language learners.

References

- Ahmadi, Y. F., Firdausi, Y. A., & Gunawan, W. 2023. Analisis Wacana Kritis dalam Bidang Pendidikan: Analisis Bibliometrik. *Ranah: Jurnal Kajian Bahasa*, 13(1), 43-57.
- Ariawan, D. A., Nurkamto, J., & Sumardi. 2022. Critical Discourse Analysis of Cultural Representations in EFL National Commercial Textbooks. *Studies in English Language and Education*, 9(1), 24579.
- Budiyanto, D., & Ridho, M. R. 2024. The Social Media Discourse Analysis to Improve Students' EFL Critical Thingking in Universitas Tridianti. *Global Expert: Jurnal Bahasa dan Sastra*, 12(1) 5-13.
- Hapsari, Y. T., & Fauzi, A. 2025. Uncovering Cultural Representation in an Indonesian EFL Textbook: A Critical Discourse Analysis for Professional Communication Competence. *Journal of Innovation Research and Knowledge*, 4(12), 9419-9432.
- Khoirunisa, F., Suryaman, M., & Yanto, E. S. 2024. Moral Education in ELT: A Critical Discourse Analysis of Tolerance Values Represented in Indonesian EFL Textbooks. *ELTIN Journal*, 9(2), 88-100.
- Martin, J. 2023. The Role of Discourse Analysis in Modern Language Education. *Frontiers of Language and Communication Studies*, 5(1), 40.

- Ningrum, D. P. S., & Ahmad, Y. B. 2024. Critical Discourse Analysis of Cultural Diversitt Depictes in Indonesian EFL Secondary School Textbook: English. *Journal of English Development*, 4(2), 317-328.
- Putri, F. D., Djatmika, D., & Putra, K. A. 2024. Framing Culture in EFL Textbooks: A Critical Discourse Analysis at Islamic School. *AL-ISHLAH: Jurnal Pendidikan*, 15(3), 4417.
- Sari, W. P., Setyonegoro, A., & Priyanto, P. 2025. Analisis Wacana Kritis Norman Fairclough pada Pemberitaan Internasionalisasi Bahasa Indonesia di Media Antarnews.com. *ISOLEK: Jurnal Pendidikan, Pengajaran, Bahasa, dan Sastra*, 3(1), 366-379.
- Susanto, S., & Chojimah, N. 2024. Unveiling Gender Portrayals in Indonesian EFL Textbooks: A Critical Discourse Analysis. *JEELS (Journal of English Education and Linguistics Studies)*, 11(2), 579-599.
- Tarigan, P. E., Gurusinga, Y. L., Panjaitan, Y. R. Y., & Siregar, M. W. 2024. Analisis Wacana Kritis pada Berita Nadiem Tegaskan Kenaikan UKT Berlaku Bagi Mahasiswa Baru pada Idntimes.com. *Simpati: Jurnal Penelitian Pendidikan dan Bahasa*, 2(3), 38-44.
- Tsany, H. A., Nurbayan, Y., & Nurmala, M. 2024. Analisis Pola Interaksi Wacana Kelas dalam Pembelajaran Bahasa Arab di Sekolah Dasar. *Jurnal Pendidikan dan Pembelajaran Indonesia (JPPI)*, 4(2), 556-571.
- Wulandari, S. A., & Sabardila, A. 2023. Kohesi Gramatikal dan Leksikal Wacana Berita Penyanyi Putri Ariani pada Media Online. *Jurnal Basataka (JBT)*, 6(2), 429-441.
- Zhang, L., & Jocuns, A. 2024. Critical Discourse Analipsis and Its Implication in English Language Teaching: A Case Study of Encironmental News Text. *ABAC ODI JOURNAL Vision. Action. Outcome*, 11(2), 258-280.

Zhou, X., Zhang, Y., & Li, J. 2023. Enhancing EFL Education: The Role of Metadiscourse in Language Assessment. *Journal of Education Research and Evaluation*, 8(3), 123-135.